

ENG 101
Lesson -12
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Consider two incidents. Write down on a piece of paper what you might infer if you saw the following two occurrences.

i) A high school has policemen walking up and down its main hall.

What would you infer? _____

ii) A dog shrinks or cringes when you try to pat him.

What would you infer? _____

Look at the following two pictures on your screen and put a tick mark against the inference(s) most logically supported by the information given in the picture.

Picture 1:

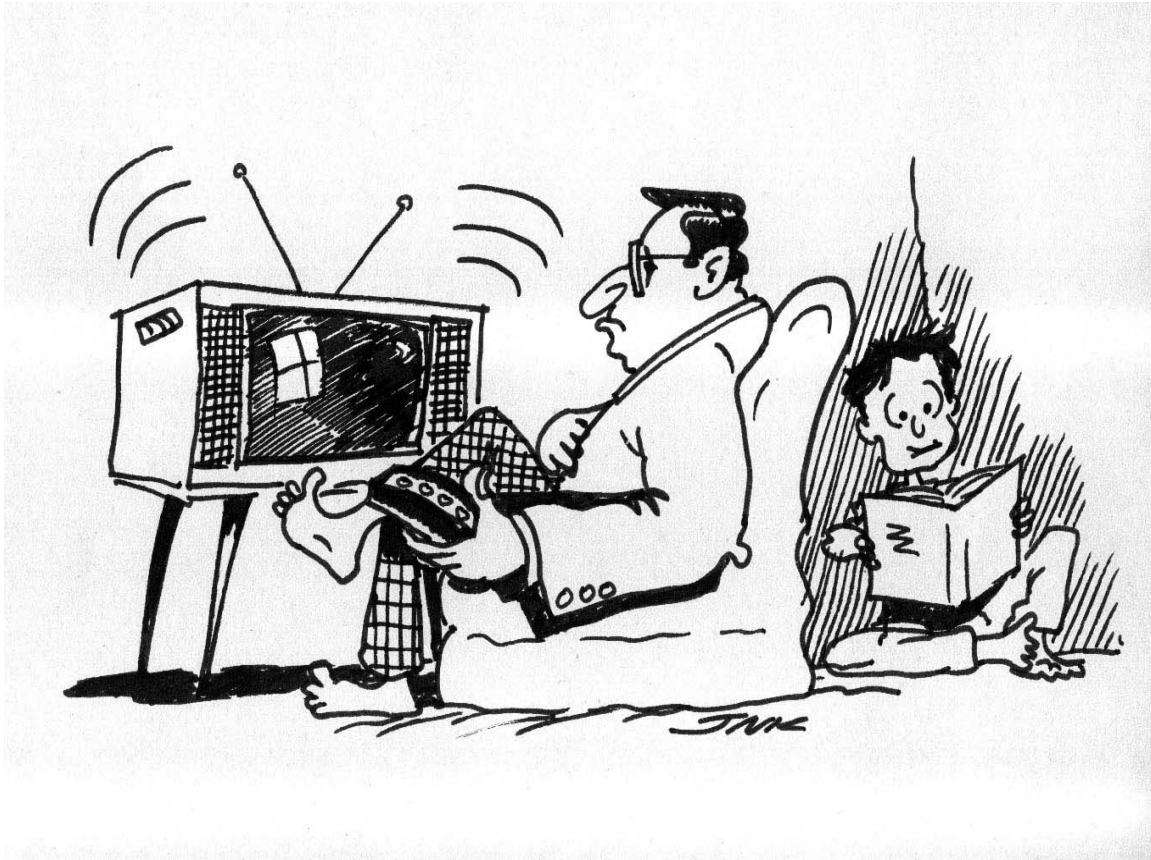


The old woman is asking for something.

The old woman couldn't see because of the smoke.

The old woman was pointing to a no-smoking sign.

Picture 2.



The man has a problem with his vision.

The boy is doing his home work.

The man watches a lot of TV.

The father cannot read.

Read the sentences given on your screen and put a tick mark by the inference most logically based on the information in the sentence.

Sohail always sits in the last row of the classroom.

- a. Sohail dislikes his college courses.
- b. Sohail is unprepared for his class.
- c. Sohail feels uncomfortable sitting in the front row.
- d. Sohail is farsighted.

Now you will have some more practice in drawing inferences. Read the given sentences and put a tick mark by the inference, most logically supported by the information given in the sentence.

1. The Arabic language contains numerous words describing different types of camels.

- a. There is really only one kind of camel.
- b. The Arabic language clearly has many times more words than the English language.
- c. The Arabic language probably also has numerous words for different types of dates.
- d. The exact nature of camels is important to the desert way of life.

2. A man enters his office building, marches past a group of fellow employees without returning their greetings and goes into his office, slamming the door.

- a. The man has just lost his job
- b. The man has quarreled with his boss.
- c. The man is in a bad mood.
- d. The man is angry with his wife.

Read the passage & then check the four statements which are most logically supported by the information given.

The elimination of jobs because of super-automation is not limited to industrial factories – offices are increasingly electronic. Engineers and architects now draw three dimensional designs, update them, test them, and store them almost instantaneously in a computer. Agriculture employs robot fruit pickers and sheepshearers, computerized irrigation systems that use sensors to calculate water and fertilizer needs in different parts of a field, and automated chicken houses.

Retail stores, banks, and brokerage houses use on-line transaction processing to obtain instant information and to conduct transactions. Laser scanning and bar codes are transforming the physical handling of codes by retailers and wholesale distributors. A final example of technological change affecting jobs is the widespread use of televisions, telephones, and personal computers for the purposes of home banking and shopping.

- 1. Computers will soon replace engineers and architects.
- 2. There will be more jobs for people who run and repair electronic devices.
- 3. One function of superautomation is the handling and storage of information.
- 4. Restaurants can't benefit from superautomation.
- 5. Machines can help company employees accomplish more.
- 6. Superautomation requires few adjustments from society.
- 7. Superautomation has advantages and disadvantages.
- 8. Laser technology is limited to the business world.

1 a) You might like to ask why the Sun is able to supply its own light, heat, and energy, whereas the Earth and the other planets only shine feebly with the aid of borrowed light. Strange as it may seem, it is best to start this problem by Strange as it may seem, it is best to start this problem by considering the interior of the Earth.

b) The morrow brought a very sober-looking morning, the sun making only a few efforts to appear; and Catherine augured from it everything most favourable to her wishes. A bright morning so early in the year, she allowed, would generally turn to rain; but a cloudy one foretold improvement as the day advanced.

c) Your mother and I were so happy then. It seemed as though we had everything we could ever want. I think the last day the sun shone was when that dirty little train steamed out of that crowded, suffocating Indian station, and the battalion band playing for all it was worth. I knew in my heart it was all over then. Everything.

“Sixty – Eight Birthday”

As life runs on, the road grows strange
With faces new, and near the end
The milestones into headstones change,
'Neath every one a friend.

J. R. Lowell

Milestone: a slab of stone set up in the ground to show the distance in miles on a road.

Headstone: a stone which marks the top end of a grave, usually having the buried person's name on it

Fog

The fog comes
On little cat feet.
It sits looking one's harbor and city

On silent haunches
reports of observations.)

Some more points about fact and opinion.

When separating fact from opinion keep in mind that:

i) **A statement of fact may be found to be un-true.**

Sometimes, evidence may show a fact is not really true.

ii) **Opinions may be masked as facts.**

People sometimes present their opinions as facts. e.g.

a) The economy, in fact, is in the worst shape it's been in for years.

b) In point of fact, neither candidate for the Nazim's office is well qualified.

c) The truth of the matter is that frozen meat tastes as good as fresh meat.

At the first glance, the above statements appear as statements of fact but a closer examination will show that they are statements of opinion.

iii) **Value-words often represent opinions.**

Value-words are generally subjective, not objective and they express judgment while factual statements report on observed reality while subjective statements interpret reality for instance.

Some Value-Words

good	bad	great
best	worst	terrible
better	lovely	wonder
worse	disgusting	

Facts Versus Opinion

Read the following statements and decide whether they are *facts* or *opinions* :

1. Edgar Allan Poe is the greatest writer of horror stories in the world. _____
2. Poe had to leave the University of Virginia because he couldn't pay his debts. _____
3. Edgar Allan Poe should not have drunk so much. _____
4. Lovecraft has often been compared to Edgar Allah Poe. _____
5. When Lovecraft died, he was practically unknown. _____
6. Lovecraft died in conditions of shameful neglect. _____
7. Lovecraft's stories are far more horrible than those of Edgar Allan Poe. _____
8. Edgar Allan Poe's stories reflect his powerful imagination and his love for analysis. _____
9. Baudelaire wrote that Edgar Poe 'pursued imagination and subjected it to the most stringent analysis'. _____
10. It is because of Baudelaire that Edgar Allan Poe became famous in France _____

Grellet, Francoise *Developing Reading Skills*, CUP, 1981, page 239

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Table 2

Simultaneous with given time-reference, i.e. during

TIME RELATERS

Adjectives	Contemporary	Simultaneous
Adverbials	at present at this point now today for the time being at the moment	meaning meanwhile in the meantime when at the same time

Subsequent to time-reference, i.e. **after**

TIME RELATERS

Adjectives Adverbials	following afterwards after that eventually	later since since then by the time	next by the end soon next
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Sample Paragraph

Computers, as we know them **today**, haven't been around for a long time. It wasn't **until** the mid-1940s that the first working digital computer was completed. But **since then**, computers have evolved tremendously. Vacuum tubes were used in the first-generation computers **at the beginning** of the 1960s. **By the end** of the 1960s transistors were replaced by tiny integrated circuit boards and, consequently, a new generation of computers was on the market. Fourth-generation computers are **now** produced with circuits that are much smaller than **before** and fit on a single chip. **Soon** fifth-generation computers will be produced, and these will no doubt be better than their predecessors.

Exercise

Read the following paragraph and as you read, underline the time relaters.

There are some who say that computers have a very short history but, because they are machines that manipulate numbers, others disagree. More than 5000 years ago, a need to count was recognized, and somebody had the idea of using first his fingers, then pebbles to keep track of the count.

History is not clear as to whether the need was recognized before or after the idea occurred. Since that time, the abacus was invented and some form of it was used well into the 16th century. During the 17th and 18th centuries many easy ways of calculating were devised. Logarithm tables, calculus and the basis for the modern slide rule were born out of that period of time. It was not until the early 1800s that the first calculating machine appeared and not too long after, Charles Babbage designed a machine which became the basis for building today's computers.

A hundred years later the first analog computer was built, but the first digital computer was not complete until 1944. Since then computers have gone through four generations

from digital computers using vacuum tubes in the 1950s, transistors in the early 1960s, integrated in the mid-60s, and a single chip in the 1970s. At the rate computer technology is growing now, we can expect more changes in this field by the end of this decade.